

Hiint Game Design Document

1. Game Overview

1.1 Game Title:

Hiint

1.2 High Concept:

Hiint is a puzzle platforming murder mystery adventure full of memorable characters and thrilling mystery.

1.3 Genre:

Puzzle Platformer

1.4 Target Audience:

Hiint is targeted towards young adult pc gamers who enjoy humorous story based games and casual gaming experiences focused on story.

1.5 Platforms:

Our game will be for PC only.

1.6 Key Selling Points:

- Unique Story
 - Crazy puzzling
 - Progression through Collection
 - Multiple Storylines
 - Fun Power-ups
 - Unique Items
 - Engaging Characters
-

2. Gameplay

2.1 Core Gameplay Mechanics:

Our game's core mechanics are made to feel very familiar to the player. The mechanics of the game are made to allow the player to explore our world through means they are familiar

with. This shows movement that is very common to platforming, including power-ups like a dash and a double jump. Players will collect items into an inventory, like many puzzle games, that can be used to complete puzzles. The game will feature lots of dialogue, to introduce the characters in the game, including multiple dialogue options that will effect character interactions.

2.2 Objectives:

The goal for the player is to catch the killer. You will chase the killer through multiple rooms of the mansion, until the killer is cornered. At the end, the player is prompted to guess the identity of the killer, ultimately completing the chase.

2.3 Player Experience Goals:

We want the player to be charmed by the atmosphere of the world and the characters within it. We want them to laugh at the characters, be surprised by the reveals, and be curious about the history of the mansion.

2.4 Progression System:

While the storyline of our game is linear, and could be mostly experienced in one playthrough, we suspect players to want to play through the storyline more than once. Each time the game is played, a new killer is selected. This killer will drop unique Hiints for the player to collect, which are stored in the cabin even after reset, and provide some unique solutions to certain puzzles. Players can admire their collection, and enjoy a reward of one final playthrough once they have collected all the Hiints.

2.5 Controls and Input:

The controls for Hiint are customizable, however they are quite simple. By default, the arrow keys or the WASD can be used for movement, with W(up) being used for jump, and S(down) used to fast fall. A double jump is performed by pressing jump in the air, and a dash is performed by pressing shift in the air. Players interact with NPCs and other things in their environment with E. Players will also select dialogue options with the number keys.

3. Story and Setting

3.1 Narrative Overview:

You find yourself at a dinner party for the late Kuznetsov at his estate, the Kuznetsov Castle. The butler greets you at the door and brings you to the table where you find a whole crew waiting for you. After introducing yourself the lights go out and Marvin dies. It's up to you to

make your way through the mansion and figure out who murdered Marvin. You chase the killer through the mansion's bizarre architecture until he is caught and brought to justice

3.2 World and Lore:

Hiint takes place in a town called Hiinterton. It is a completely normal town besides the giant gothic russian castle in the woods nearby. The mansion was owned by the Kusnetzov family of Russia, its first full time residents being 3 siblings who moved there in the 1800s. The sole heir of the mansion recently passed, and upon his death requested a dinner party at the mansion, with members of the community.

3.3 Characters:

Butler: The butler tends to the mansion and provides for the upkeep. He greets you and brings you to the table for dinner.

Sargent Relish: An army man, a fighter, and a father. The sarge is not afraid to speak his mind, but at the end of the day, he is a big softy when he goes home to his daughters.

Magenta Lovelace: The distinguished Ms. Lovelace seems to be the most prepared for a fancy dinner with a powerful family. Her words are very sweet, although, it's hard to tell if she is genuine

Dmitri: A man in a tall trench coat. He speaks in a heavy accent and has terrible grammar. Although he says his name is Dmitri, he sometimes refers to himself as Boris. Dmitri is hiding a big secret. Beneath it all, he is actually 2 hyper-intelligent russian penguins in a trench coat

Henry Conroy: A man who has built quite the name for himself. Banned from 4 states and all casinos, Henry does not seem like someone that should be trusted, especially when he asks to use your watch for a "magic trick"

Diane: The first to greet you as you enter, Diane seems like a real friend. Although she isn't the nicest to her brother, she is very kind to everyone else

Marvin: Diane's younger brother Marvin seems like quite the pest. He only speaks in jokes and cannot take a situation seriously. He hides a dark past, but none of that is discovered until after his untimely death at the dinner party

3.4 Story Structure:

The character begins in a cabin outside the mansion. Upon collecting a torch, the player walks towards the mansion, avoiding stumps and changes in the terrain. Upon reaching the mansion, the player is greeted by the Butler, and invited to enter the mansion. The player joins the dinner table with all of our characters, who converse at the table, and introduce themselves one by one. Seconds later, the lights in the mansion flicker and go out, and Marvin is killed. The lights were out long enough for anyone in the mansion to be the possible culprit. As you leave the

dining room, you witness a cloaked figure sneak into the library. You must chase the killer. After escaping the library and moving to the lounge, you witness the killer escape down a hatch that closes behind him. After finding the way to open the hatch, you chase behind the killer into the dungeon. Through cages and jumps over pits of certain doom, you chase the killer back to the dining room, where you have to guess who it was that killed him. If you guess right, justice is served, otherwise, he escapes out of the front door.

4. Art and Aesthetics

4.1 Visual Style:

Our game follows a dark pixel art aesthetic that initially fools the player into thinking the game will be scary and serious, before meeting our cast of characters, and learning the game is much more lighthearted.

4.2 Character Design:

Characters are inspired partially by the characters in clue. All designs are original and created completely by the team.

4.3 Environment Design:

The environment of the game is mostly indoors in a giant mansion.

4.4 User Interface (UI):

The ui is simple. The top left of the screen has an inventory with 5 slots, and the top middle has a text box and an image of the person speaking when dialogue is initiated

5. Audio Design

5.1 Music:

Music is inspired by classic video game soundtracks. It serves to add to the suspense of the game, and is chosen to remain darker to help with the comedic contrast with some of our story and character design choices

5.2 Sound Effects:

Sound effects include walking, jumping and dashing sounds, in order to audibly cue the player when they perform an action. There will also be a lot of sound cues for puzzling, for instance the sound of a door opening, so that a player knows their action had an effect on the environment.

5.3 Voice Acting:

All NPCs are voice acted. The main character will not be voice acted

6. Technical Specifications

6.1 Engine and Tools:

Game was created using the GODOT4 engine in GODOT.

6.2 Performance Targets:

The game is expected to perform at 60 frames on most gaming computers, given it is not that resource intensive.

6.3 Online Features:

none

7. Level Design

7.1 Level Flow:

Levels exist as puzzles. One room will have a puzzle to escape it, much like an escape room. The Library has a puzzle to get 3 autobiographies which must be placed on lecterns in a certain order to open the door. The billiards room/lounge involves finding the code for a safe that contains an 8 ball which can be used to open the dungeon. The dungeon has multiple lever puzzles, and a platforming puzzle to get a key

7.2 Pacing:

The game is meant to challenge the mind more than the gaming skills of a player. The game will be paced slowly, until the final level, where the player will chase the killer and try not to lose them in the dungeon.

7.3 Key Locations:

The dining room is the main dialogue location. It is where the player will meet all the NPCs, and where the final confrontation will take place.

8. Monetization and Distribution

8.1 Pricing Model:

Free to play

8.2 In-Game Monetization:

None

8.3 Distribution Platforms:

Steam

9. Production Plan

9.1 Development Timeline:

Begin production Feb 2025, First playable version of the game Mar 2025, Additional Level creation and story integration May 2025

9.2 Team and Roles:

Corey Lundgren: Team Lead

Thomas Warnke: Lead Developer

Andrew Gotziaman: Testing Lead and Secondary Developer

Jonathon Solhjem: Creative Lead

9.3 Budget:

100\$
